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Star Trek: the top 10 commons and uncommons in each color

The commons and uncommons to look for at the prerelease, best first in each color. Each card gets one word, one line on why, and the reasons.

Great
take it early

Good
happy to play it

Playable
an average card that does its job

White



1 Rutherford, Upgraded Ensign 2

Great

Draw your Spacecraft with this. Needs 8+ artifacts in your deck; with 4 it's a coin flip.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in ECL, EOE: 4.9 points above an average card when drawn, better than 98% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+6.2**



EOE · **+0.8**



ECL · **+7.6**



2 Federation Field Medic 3

Great

A 2-for-1 at common. With 6 counter cards in your deck it draws about 3 times in 4 (Spacecraft, Sagas and Missions count, and so does an earlier Medic); the worst case is a 4/3 vigilance.

> **Track record** 2 similar cards in MSH, SOS: 2.8 points above an average card when drawn, better than 89% of commons and uncommons.



MSH · **+3.2**



SOS · **+2.3**



3 U.S.S. Excelsior, Cutting Edge 3

Great

A removal spell that turns into a win condition? Sign me up.



4 Malfunctioning Holodeck 2

Good

White's answer to anything, bombs included.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in EOE, MSH: 1.9 points above an average card when drawn, better than 82% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 0.15 played C/U answers per pack that remove it (and give the card back) (in past sets: 0.21): better for it.



EOE · **+3.3**



MSH · **+2.8**



MSH · **-0.4**



FRA · new, no games yet



5 Free Borg Revolutionaries 3

Playable

Land early, finisher late. Never a dead draw.

> **Track record** 7 similar cards in ECL, MSH, TLA: 0.1 points above an average card when drawn, better than 53% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+0.5**



MSH · **-0.5**



MSH · **-0.3**



ECL · **+2.5**



6 Command Decision 1

Good

Kills the big one, or cycles. Never dead.

> **Track record** 2 similar cards in HOB, SOS: 2.4 points above an average card when drawn, better than 85% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 25% of the creatures you meet are legal targets (power 4 or more) (in past sets: 34%): worse for it.



HOB · **+3.5**



SOS · **+1.2**



7 Ghost of Illyria 3

Good

A flyer that doubles up your best enters effect.

> **Our judgment** The only past blink creature, Ennis, was a 2-mana 1/1; this is a 3/3 flyer for 4 that also replays your best enters effect.

> **Its effect in general** Its only past version did 4.2 points worse than average (4th of C/U).



8 Assembly Specialist 1

Good

Two bodies for two: the Borg deck's favorite opener.

> **Track record** 2 similar cards in EOE, TLA: 1.4 points above an average card when drawn, better than 76% of commons and uncommons.



TLA · **+1.1**



EOE · **+1.8**



9 Test of Conviction 1

PLAYABLE

Counters on your whole team in the go-wide deck; otherwise a fair draw-two.

> **Our judgment** One comparable, a gold spell; the team-counters mode is the reason to play it.

> **Track record** 1 similar card in SOS: 2.6 points above an average card when drawn, better than 87% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 34% of the creatures you meet cost 2 or less (in past sets: 42%): better for it.



SOS · **+2.6**



10 Dr. McCoy, Surly Surgeon 2

PLAYABLE

A counters-deck card; elsewhere just a weak 4-drop.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in EOE, MSH, SOS: 0.8 points above an average card when drawn, better than 66% of commons and uncommons.



MSH · **-0.6**



EOE · **+4.0**



SOS · **-0.9**



FRA · new, no games yet

Blue



1 V'Ger, the Intruder 6

Good

Expensive, but if it lives two turns the game is over.

> Track record 2 similar cards in ECL, EOE: 3.2 points above an average card when drawn, better than 91% of commons and uncommons.



EOE · **+2.4**



ECL · **+4.1**



FRA · new, no games yet



FRA · new, no games yet



2 Cloistered Telepath 1

Good

Cheap, flexible, always useful.

> Track record 3 similar cards in EOE, HOB: 2.8 points above an average card when drawn, better than 89% of commons and uncommons.

> In Star Trek 34% of the creatures you meet cost 2 or less (in past sets: 39%): better for it.



HOB · **+0.8**



EOE · **+4.4**



EOE · **+3.3**



FRA · new, no games yet



3 Open Communications

Good

Costs you nothing, gives you two cards over a game.

> Track record 4 similar cards in HOB, SOS: 1.8 points above an average card when drawn, better than 80% of commons and uncommons.

> In Star Trek 34% of the creatures you meet cost 2 or less (in past sets: 42%): better for it.

> In Star Trek 47% of the creatures you'd play in its colors have an enters trigger (worth replaying) here, vs 41% on average in the sets with data.

> In Star Trek 0.06 removal auras per pack that returning your creature undoes here, vs 0.07 on average in the sets with data.



SOS · **+0.9**



HOB · **+1.9**



SOS · **+1.9**



SOS · **+2.5**



4 Suurok-Class Science Vessel 2

Good

Can't lose a card on it, and it flies.



5 Interstellar Effigy 4{b}

GOOD

A tempo swing that often wins the race.



6 Zefram Cochrane, Warp Pioneer 2{b}

GOOD

Card advantage engine for artifact decks.



7 Hoshi Sato, Exolinguist 4{b}

PLAYABLE

Rewards a deck of many creature types.

> TRACK RECORD 2 similar cards in HOB, SOS: 0.0 points below an average card when drawn, better than 50% of commons and uncommons.

> IN STAR TREK 34% of the creatures you meet cost 2 or less (in past sets: 42%): better for it.



SOS · **-0.1**



HOB · **+0.0**



8 Dominion Saboteur 4

PLAYABLE

Exactly as good as the best card on the table.

> TRACK RECORD 1 similar card in ECL: 0.7 points above an average card when drawn, better than 64% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+0.7**



9 Consider the Prime Directive 2

PLAYABLE

Flexible, but it waits for them to act.

> TRACK RECORD 5 similar cards in EOE, HOB, MSH, SOS, TLA: 0.9 points above an average card when drawn, better than 67% of commons and uncommons.



HOB · **-2.2**



TLA · **+1.6**



SOS · **+1.8**



MSH · **+2.4**



10 Federation Probe

Good

A tiny flyer that never sits in your hand.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in EOE, MSH, TLA: 0.1 points above an average card when drawn, better than 54% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 12% of the creatures you meet can block a flyer (in past sets: 21%): better for it.



MSH · **+1.0**



EOE · **-0.3**



TLA · **-0.2**



FRA · new, no games yet

Black



1 Eject the Warp Core 1

GOOD

Cheap removal that scales when you need it.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in MSH, SOS, TLA: 1.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 76% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 75% of the creatures you meet die to it (toughness 2 or less; -6 when kicked, counted half) (in past sets: 51%): better for it.

> **In Star Trek** 39% of the C/U cards you'd play in its colors are artifacts or make tokens (things to sacrifice) here, vs 20% on average in the sets with data.



SOS · **+2.7**



MSH · **+1.6**



TLA · **+0.1**



FRA · new, no games yet



2 He's Dead, Jim 3

Good

The name is the review.

> **Track record** 5 similar cards in EOE, HOB, MSH, SOS, TLA: 1.4 points above an average card when drawn, better than 76% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 25% of the creatures you meet have power 4 or more (worth a full answer) (in past sets: 20%): better for it.



EOE · **+1.1**



TLA · **+1.4**



SOS · **+1.2**



MSH · **+1.9**



3 Rogue Artificial Intelligence 4

Good

Land early, finisher late. Never dead.

> **Track record** 6 similar cards in ECL, MSH, TLA: 0.0 points above an average card when drawn, better than 51% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+2.5**



TLA · **-2.1**



MSH · **+0.1**



MSH · **-0.5**



4 Gabriel Lorca, Mirror Menace 4

GOOD

Removal only delays him.



5 D'Ghor Bloodletter 2

GOOD

Removal with a body attached.

> ITS EFFECT IN GENERAL Its only past version did 2.4 points better than average (86th of C/U).



6 Resistance Is Futile 1

GOOD

Cheap removal. Resistance is futile.

> TRACK RECORD 2 similar cards in HOB, SOS: 2.9 points above an average card when drawn, better than 90% of commons and uncommons.

> IN STAR TREK 73% of the creatures you meet are legal targets (nonartifact) (in past sets: 99%): worse for it.



SOS · **+4.2**



HOB · **+1.5**



7 Commander Raffi Musiker 2

Good

Trading with it still nets you a card.



8 In the Pale Moonlight 3

Good

Three turns, three cards' worth.

> **Track record** 1 similar card in EOE: 0.1 points below an average card when drawn, better than 49% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 39% of the C/U cards you'd play in its colors are artifacts or make tokens (things to sacrifice) here, vs 20% on average in the sets with data.



EOE · **-0.1**



9 Battle-Scarred Survivalist 1

Good

Grows into a real threat by midgame.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in HOB, MSH, TLA: 1.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 77% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 12% of the creatures you meet can block a flyer (in past sets: 22%): better for it.



MSH · **+1.3**



TLA · **+0.0**



HOB · **+3.2**



FRA · new, no games yet



10 Bat'leth 2

Good

A 2-for-1 in a sword.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in ECL, HOB, MSH: 1.3 points above an average card when drawn, better than 75% of commons and uncommons.



HOB · **+4.2**



MSH · **+0.6**



ECL · **-0.7**

Red



1 Khaaaaaaaaaaannn! X

Good

Scales with the game, and worth the scream.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in ECL, EOE, SOS: 2.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 86% of commons and uncommons.



SOS · **+2.5**



ECL · **+3.1**



EOE · **+1.7**



2 Planetary Bombardment

Good

One-mana removal. Cast it after combat.

> **Track record** 5 similar cards in ECL, EOE, MSH, SOS: 1.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 77% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 50% of the creatures you meet die to it (toughness 2 or less) (in past sets: 36%): better for it.



EOE · **+1.3**



SOS · **-0.1**



SOS · **+1.8**



ECL · **+2.4**



3 Savvy Profiteer {1}{R}

Good

Ramp for big red decks.

> **Track record** 1 similar card in EOE: 1.7 points above an average card when drawn, better than 79% of commons and uncommons.



EOE · **+1.7**



4 Munitions Enthusiast {1}{R}

Good

Blocking it always costs them something.

> **Its effect in general** Its only past version did 0.0 points better than average (51st of C/U).



5 Khan, Despot by Design 4{R}

Good

A one-sided sweeper with a big body.

> **Its effect in general** Its only past version did 2.4 points better than average (86th of C/U).



6 Transporter Malfunction 1

GOOD

Two removal spells in one slot.

> **Track record** 10 similar cards in ECL, EOE, HOB, MSH, SOS, TLA: 2.2 points above an average card when drawn, better than 84% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 74% of the creatures you meet die to it (toughness 3 or less) (in past sets: 82%): worse for it.

> **In Star Trek** 24% of the creatures you'd play in its colors have an enters trigger (worth replaying) here, vs 32% on average in the sets with data.

> **In Star Trek** 0.06 removal auras per pack that returning your creature undoes here, vs 0.07 on average in the sets with data.



SOS · **+2.5**



TLA · **+4.0**



ECL · **+3.1**



EOE · **+1.7**



7 Captain Michael Burnham 2

GOOD

Steady pressure that taxes every land you play.

> OUR JUDGMENT Two comparables, one gold; a 3/3 trampler that pings every land drop keeps up pressure.

> TRACK RECORD 2 similar cards in EOE: 0.7 points below an average card when drawn, better than 39% of commons and uncommons.



EOE · **+0.7**



EOE · **-2.0**



FRA · new, no games yet



8 Plasma Cascade 2

GOOD

Removal that smooths your draws.

> TRACK RECORD 6 similar cards in ECL, EOE, HOB, MSH, SOS, TLA: 1.7 points above an average card when drawn, better than 79% of commons and uncommons.

> IN STAR TREK 74% of the creatures you meet die to it (toughness 3 or less) (in past sets: 82%): worse for it.



SOS · **+2.0**



ECL · **+1.3**



EOE · **+0.2**



TLA · **+2.3**



9 Genesis Effect {4}{R}

Playable

Kills almost anything, and the land tax is tiny.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in ECL, MSH, SOS: 0.1 points above an average card when drawn, better than 53% of commons and uncommons.



SOS · **+0.3**



ECL · **+1.3**



MSH · **-1.2**



FRA · new, no games yet



10 Exploratory Mission {2}{R}{R}

Playable

Slow start, then an avalanche.

Green



1 Amok Time 2🌳

GOOD

Removal, life and a creature back: no dull chapter.

> TRACK RECORD 4 similar cards in ECL, HOB, SOS, TLA: 0.1 points above an average card when drawn, better than 52% of commons and uncommons.



SOS · **-2.3**



ECL · **+2.5**



TLA · **-0.8**



HOB · **+0.8**



2 U.S.S. Voyager, Lone Wanderer 3🌳

GOOD

Ramp now, threat later.



3 Adversary by Algorithm 2🌳

GOOD

Two bodies from one card.

> IN STAR TREK 44% of the creatures you'd play in its colors have an enters trigger (worth replaying) here, vs 36% on average in the sets with data.

> IN STAR TREK 0.06 removal auras per pack that returning your creature undoes here, vs 0.07 on average in the sets with data.



4 David and Carol Marcus, Creators

2{G}

GOOD

Ramp and your splash in one card.

> TRACK RECORD 4 similar cards in ECL, MSH, SOS, TLA: 1.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 77% of commons and uncommons.



TLA · **+1.5**



MSH · **+3.7**



SOS · **+1.4**



ECL · **-0.6**



5 Mugato 3{G}{G}

GOOD

Nothing gets past.

> TRACK RECORD 5 similar cards in ECL, EOE, HOB, MSH, SOS: 1.8 points above an average card when drawn, better than 81% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+1.2**



SOS · **+4.9**



EOE · **-0.5**



MSH · **+4.7**



6 Common Goal 1

GOOD

Green's removal, and nothing hits back.

> TRACK RECORD 7 similar cards in ECL, EOE, HOB, SOS, TLA: 2.3 points above an average card when drawn, better than 85% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+2.6**



TLA · **+1.3**



SOS · **+1.8**



HOB · **+2.5**



7 Saurian Explorer 3

GOOD

Hits hard on land turns.

> TRACK RECORD 3 similar cards in EOE, MSH: 2.1 points above an average card when drawn, better than 83% of commons and uncommons.



EOE · **-0.1**



EOE · **+1.1**



MSH · **+5.4**



8 Xenobotanist 1

GOOD

Splash your bomb, then block with your fixing.

> TRACK RECORD 4 similar cards in ECL, MSH, SOS, TLA: 1.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 77% of commons and uncommons.



TLA · **+1.5**



MSH · **+3.7**



SOS · **+1.4**



ECL · **-0.6**



9 Species 8472 4

GOOD

Against the Borg, practically unblockable.



10 Jake Sisko, War Correspondent 1

Good

Small numbers that add up.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in EOE, HOB: 1.0 points above an average card when drawn, better than 69% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 34% of the creatures you meet cost 2 or less (in past sets: 39%): better for it.



EOE · **+1.0**



HOB · **+1.4**



EOE · **+0.7**

Multicolor and colorless



1 Spock, Always Your Friend

Great

A 2-drop that draws your removal. Needs 10+ noncreature spells in your deck; with 6 it's a coin flip.

> **Track record** 3 similar cards in ECL: 6.0 points above an average card when drawn, better than 99% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **+5.2**



ECL · **+6.2**



ECL · **+6.6**



2 L'Rell, Fierce Visionary

Good

Defends and attacks at the same time.

> **Track record** 7 similar cards in ECL, EOE, MSH, SOS, TLA: 1.2 points above an average card when drawn, better than 73% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 28% of the C/U cards you'd play in its colors are artifacts or make tokens (things to sacrifice) here, vs 19% on average in the sets with data.



ECL · **+5.2**



TLA · **+0.8**



SOS · **+3.6**



ECL · **+2.4**



3 Cleveland Booker, Empath

Good

Every land drop becomes a creature.

> **Track record** 6 similar cards in EOE, HOB, MSH, SOS: 1.5 points above an average card when drawn, better than 77% of commons and uncommons.

> **In Star Trek** 34% of the creatures you meet cost 2 or less (in past sets: 39%): better for it.



EOE · **+1.1**



HOB · **+3.3**



SOS · **-1.4**



HOB · **+0.0**



4 Daniels, Temporal Agent

Good

The longer the game, the better the 2-for-1.

> **Track record** 2 similar cards in ECL, EOE: 1.1 points above an average card when drawn, better than 71% of commons and uncommons.



ECL · **-0.5**



EOE · **+2.8**



5 Locutus, the One Who Speaks

GOOD

A Borg lord that doubles as removal.

> ITS EFFECT IN GENERAL Its only past version did 0.3 points better than average (57th of C/U).



6 Hemmer, Fixing What Is Broken

GOOD

The W/U Spacecraft deck's engine.



7 The Duras Sisters

GOOD

Killing them costs twice.



8 U.S.S. Cerritos, Following Up

GOOD

Brings its own crew; every deck can play it.



9 Spatial Anomaly

Good

Free removal for any red deck.



10 Phlox, Unorthodox Doctor {2}{B}{G}{W}

Good

A card engine in the counters deck.

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